As an island of five-day cricket amid the unrelenting torrent of ODIs, we enjoyed the Test series against the West Indies. In the first Test at SuperSport Park in Pretoria, Hashim and I took the score from a precarious 57 for three to a position of control at 365 for three. He scored 208 and I made 152. The bowlers rose to the challenge, dismissing the tourists for 201 and then 131, securing victory by an innings and 220 runs.

Poor weather ensured the second Test ended as a draw in Port Elizabeth, but we clinched the series win with a convincing victory at Newlands. I managed to score 148 and helped build a first innings lead, and we dismissed the West Indies for 215 before scoring the 124 needed for victory by eight wickets.

Confidence was returning after the setbacks in Australia and, even though we lost both T20 internationals against the West Indies, we performed well in the ODI series, winning in Durban, winning well in Johannesburg when I scored 149 in 44 balls – as described in the opening chapter – winning in East London, losing by one wicket in Port Elizabeth and then wrapping up a confidence-boosting 4–1 series win in Centurion.

As a captain, I was happy. As a squad desperate to win the World Cup, we were ready.